

Who will protect women at home?

The country that I live in, the UAE, **consistently ranks** high on safety **indices**, and as a long-time resident here, I can **vouch** for the safety this place offers women on its streets, even at midnight. The **fact** that I do not have to **look over my shoulder**, **wary** of **stalkers**, or worry about being **groped** in a **crowded** metro **makes** this a **haven** of peace and protection for women. But safety on the roads is no guarantee of safety at home. In the past few months alone, the country has seen the **heartbreaking** suicides of young Indian women such as Athulya Shekhar, who was found dead on her 30th birthday after **allegedly enduring** years of **abuse** at the hands of her husband, and Vipanchika Maniyan, who ended her life along with her 18-month-old daughter, leaving behind a note detailing the **cruelty** she faced within her marriage. These **tragedies unfolded** not in dark **alleys** or **deserted** lanes, but **behind closed doors**, **far from** the reach of CCTV cameras and crime **statistics**. And they force us to ask: What is the meaning of a safe city, if a woman cannot feel safe in her own home? Across the Indian subcontinent (and the rest of the world), the **grim** reality of violence and abuse against women continues to unfold without being noticed or recorded. Worse still, despite all the efforts to **highlight** modern women's **valiant accomplishments** in **allied** fields, such **instances** are becoming **par for the course**. It is as if the world has become **immune** to it. Like war. Like **poverty**.

Something that goes on despite the **outcry** it raises on various platforms. In India, as we are well aware, every day women face physical, emotional, and psychological **torment** in the supposed sanctuary of their homes. The National Crime Records Bureau's **data** consistently **reveals** the shocking **prevalence** of domestic violence, **dowry** deaths, and mental health crises **triggered** by **abusive** family environments. While many women have made the **brave** decision to **walk out** of the **perilous confines**, many have remained silent, either enduring the torture forever or **eventually** ending their lives. The safety cannot be measured by police reports or CCTV footage alone. This **stark contrast** between public safety and private **hazard** **compels** us to rethink what "safety" truly means. For many women, the threat **lurking** within relatives is far more terrifying than the danger among **strangers** on the streets. And that threat is often invisible, dismissed as "family matters", "private issues", or "cultural norms". Until we break this silence and **address** domestic violence with the same **urgency** as public crime, the promise of safety remains incomplete. True safety for women is not just about well-**lit** streets or strict laws **enforced** by authorities. It is about transforming the spaces where women should feel most secure — their homes, their relationships, their communities.

As a woman living in the UAE, I **cherish** the freedom to walk safely at night, but I also carry the stories of women like Athulya, Vipanchika, and **countless** others in my heart. Their silenced voices remind me that safety is a layered, complex reality — one that demands attention beyond statistics and headlines. If we truly want to build safe societies, we must look beyond external measures and **confront** the hidden violence that **persists behind curtained windows**. Only then can we claim to have created a world where every **woman**, everywhere, **can** live without fear — not just on the streets, but in the very places that should **embody** protection and **well-being**. [Practice Exercise]

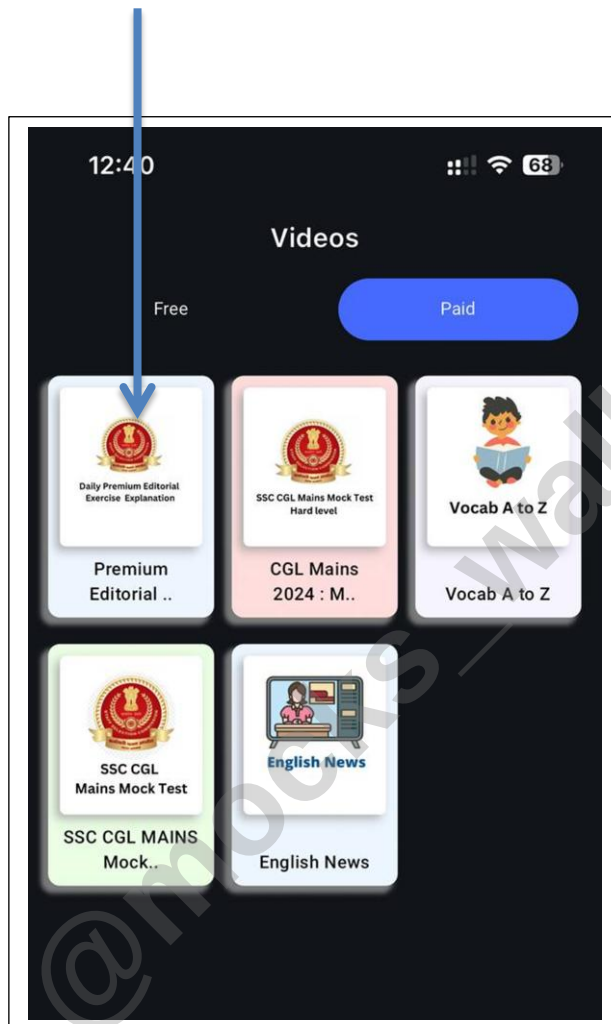
Vocabulary

1. **Consistently** (adverb) – steadily, reliably, uniformly, regularly, unfailingly
निरंतर/लगातार
2. **Indices** (noun) – indicators, measures, metrics, benchmarks, yardsticks सूचकांक
3. **Vouch** (verb) – attest, certify, affirm, testify, guarantee प्रमाण देना
4. **Look over my shoulder** (phrase) – watch one's back, keep glancing back, stay on guard, be hyper-vigilant, keep a lookout पीछा/खतरे की आशंका में चौकन्ना रहना
5. **Wary** (of) (adjective) – cautious, vigilant, circumspect, guarded, leery सतर्क/सावधान
6. **Stalker** (noun) – pursuer, harasser, shadow, prowler, tail पीछा करने वाला
7. **Grope** (in) (verb) – molest, fondle, paw, manhandle, feel up अनुचित स्पर्श करना/छेड़छाड़ करना
8. **Crowded** (adjective) – packed, jam-packed, congested, thronged, crammed भीड़ भरा
9. **Haven** (noun) – refuge, sanctuary, shelter, safe harbor, oasis सुरक्षित आश्रय/ठिकाना
10. **Heartbreaking** (adjective) – heartrending, devastating, wrenching, tragic, gutting हृदयविदारक
11. **Allegedly** (adverb) – purportedly, reportedly, supposedly, ostensibly, said to be कथित रूप से
12. **Endure** (verb) – withstand, tolerate, bear, suffer, persevere सहना/झेलना
13. **Abuse** (noun) – mistreatment, cruelty, violence, exploitation, maltreatment अत्याचार/दुर्व्यवहार
14. **Cruelty** (noun) – brutality, savagery, ruthlessness, inhumanity, callousness क्रूरता/निर्दयता
15. **Tragedy** (noun) – calamity, catastrophe, misfortune, disaster, heartbreak त्रासदी/विपत्ति
16. **Unfold** (verb) – emerge, transpire, develop, occur, play out क्रमशः सामने आना/घटित होना
17. **Alley** (noun) – lane, alleyway, backstreet, by-lane, passage संकरी गली/रास्ता
18. **Deserted** (adjective) – empty, abandoned, desolate, forlorn, unfrequented सुनसान/उजाड़
19. **Behind closed doors** (phrase) – in private, in camera, in secrecy, privately, away from public view बंद कमरों में/गुप्त रूप से
20. **Far from** (phrase) – not at all, nowhere near, anything but, remote from, distant from बिल्कुल नहीं/से बहुत दूर

21. **Statistics** (noun) – data, figures, numbers, metrics, quantitative records आँकड़े
22. **Grim** (adjective) – bleak, severe, harsh, somber, dour निराशाजनक/कठोर
23. **Highlight** (verb) – emphasize, underscore, spotlight, foreground, accentuate उजागर करना
24. **Valiant** (adjective) – brave, courageous, gallant, valorous, intrepid वीर/साहसी
25. **Accomplishment** (noun) – achievement, feat, attainment, success, realization उपलब्धि
26. **Allied** (adjective) – related, associated, connected, affiliated, ancillary संबद्ध/सहयोगी
27. **Instance** (noun) – example, case, occurrence, illustration, episode उदाहरण/घटना
28. **Par for the course** (phrase) – typical, expected, standard, customary, routine सामान्य/अपेक्षित बात
29. **Immune** (to) (adjective) – resistant, insusceptible, impervious, inured, desensitized प्रभावरोहित/प्रतिरक्षित
30. **Poverty** (noun) – destitution, penury, deprivation, want, impoverishment गरीबी/दरिद्रता
31. **Outcry** (noun) – uproar, protest, furor, clamor, backlash तीव्र विरोध/कोलाहल
32. **Torment** (noun) – agony, torture, anguish, misery, suffering यातना/कष्ट
33. **Prevalence** (noun) – incidence, frequency, pervasiveness, widespreadness, predominance प्रचलन/प्रसार
34. **Dowry** (noun) – property, cash, or goods given by the bride's family to the groom/his family at marriage दहेज
35. **Trigger** (verb) – spark, provoke, precipitate, set off, catalyze आरंभ कर देना/उकसाना
36. **Abusive** (adjective) – violent, cruel, oppressive, insulting, exploitative अपमानजनक/अत्याचारी
37. **Brave** (adjective) – courageous, valiant, bold, fearless, dauntless साहसी/निर्भीक
38. **Walk out** (phrasal verb) – leave, quit, depart, exit, storm out छोड़कर निकल जाना
39. **Perilous** (adjective) – dangerous, hazardous, risky, treacherous, precarious जोखिमपूर्ण/संकटपूर्ण
40. **Confine** (noun) – boundaries, limits, confines, enclosure, constraints सीमाएँ/परिसीमा

41. **Eventually** (adverb) – ultimately, finally, in the end, at length, sooner or later
अंततः/आखिरकार
42. **Stark** (adjective) – severe, blunt, bare, unvarnished, unmistakable कठोर/स्पष्ट
43. **Contrast** (noun) – difference, disparity, divergence, distinction, juxtaposition
विरोधाभास/भिन्नता
44. **Hazard** (noun) – danger, risk, peril, threat, jeopardy खतरा/जोखिम
45. **Compel** (verb) – force, oblige, coerce, drive, impel बाध्य/मजबूर करना
46. **Lurk** (verb) – hide, skulk, prowl, lie in wait, loiter घात लगाना/छिपकर मंडराना
47. **Stranger** (noun) – outsider, unknown person, passerby, foreigner, unfamiliar person अजनबी
48. **Address** (verb) – deal with, tackle, confront, attend to, take up
समाधान/निपटना
49. **Urgency** (noun) – immediacy, exigency, haste, press, criticality तात्कालिकता/गंभीर आवश्यकता
50. **Lit** (adjective) – illuminated, lighted, bright, well-lit, aglow प्रकाशित/रोशन
51. **Enforce** (verb) – implement, execute, uphold, impose, apply लागू कराना/प्रवर्तन करना
52. **Cherish** (verb) – treasure, value, hold dear, nurture, appreciate सहेज कर रखना/मूल्य देना
53. **Countless** (adjective) – innumerable, myriad, untold, numberless, umpteen असंख्य
54. **Confront** (verb) – face, tackle, challenge, address, stand up to सामना करना
55. **Persist** (verb) – continue, endure, persevere, prevail, linger बना रहना/जारी रहना
56. **Behind curtained windows** (phrase) – hidden from view, in private homes, out of public sight, within domestic walls, in household secrecy परदों के पीछे/घर की चारदीवारी में
57. **Embody** (verb) – represent, personify, exemplify, manifest, incarnate मूर्त रूप देना/अभिव्यक्त करना
58. **Well-being** (noun) – welfare, health, safety, prosperity, flourishing कल्याण/भलाई

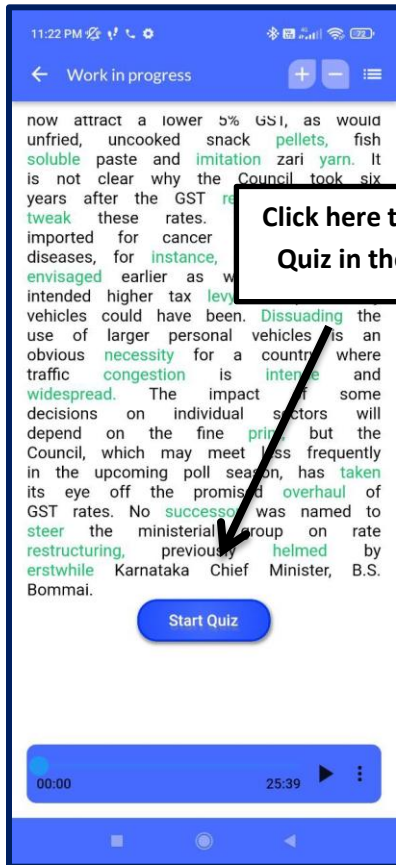
Video solution of Practice Exercise from this Editorial is exclusively available on App.



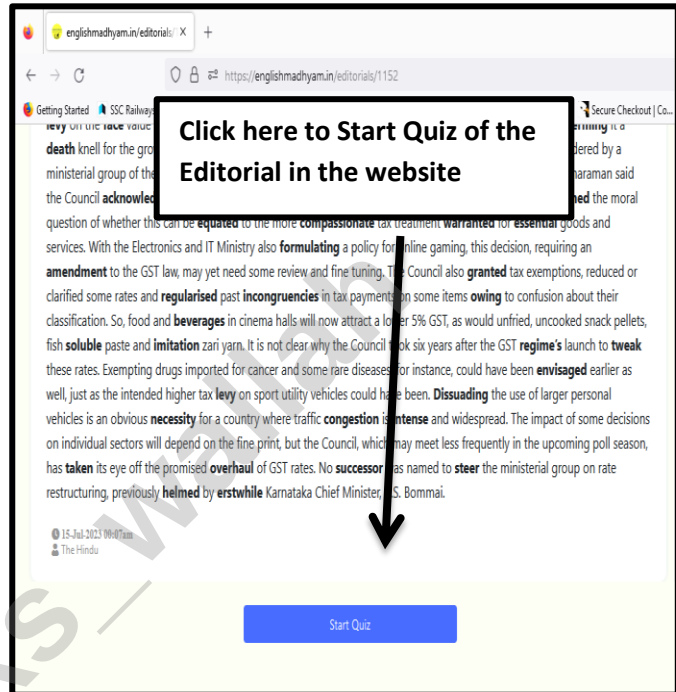
Summary of the Editorial

1. The UAE is consistently ranked high on safety indices, ensuring women's security in public spaces even at night.
2. Women in the UAE can move freely without fear of stalking, harassment, or groping in public transport.
3. Public safety does not automatically translate to safety at home.
4. Recent suicides of Indian women in the UAE, such as Athulya Shekhar and Vipanchika Maniyan, highlight domestic abuse within marriages.
5. These tragedies occurred in private homes, beyond CCTV surveillance and crime data tracking.
6. This raises a critical question: What is the meaning of a "safe city" if women are unsafe in their own homes?
7. Across South Asia and the world, domestic abuse against women often goes unnoticed and unrecorded.
8. Despite celebrating women's achievements, abuse and violence at home remain common and normalized.
9. Society appears desensitized to such violence, treating it as a persistent background issue like war or poverty.
10. In India, many women face physical, emotional, and psychological abuse within families daily.
11. NCRB data shows high prevalence of domestic violence, dowry deaths, and abuse-related mental health issues.
12. While some women escape abusive homes, many remain silent, enduring the violence or taking their own lives.
13. Safety cannot be defined solely through police records, CCTV coverage, or street infrastructure.
14. Domestic abuse is often dismissed as a "private matter" or "cultural norm," preventing effective action.
15. True safety requires tackling hidden domestic violence with urgency, ensuring women are secure not only in public but also in their homes, relationships, and communities.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



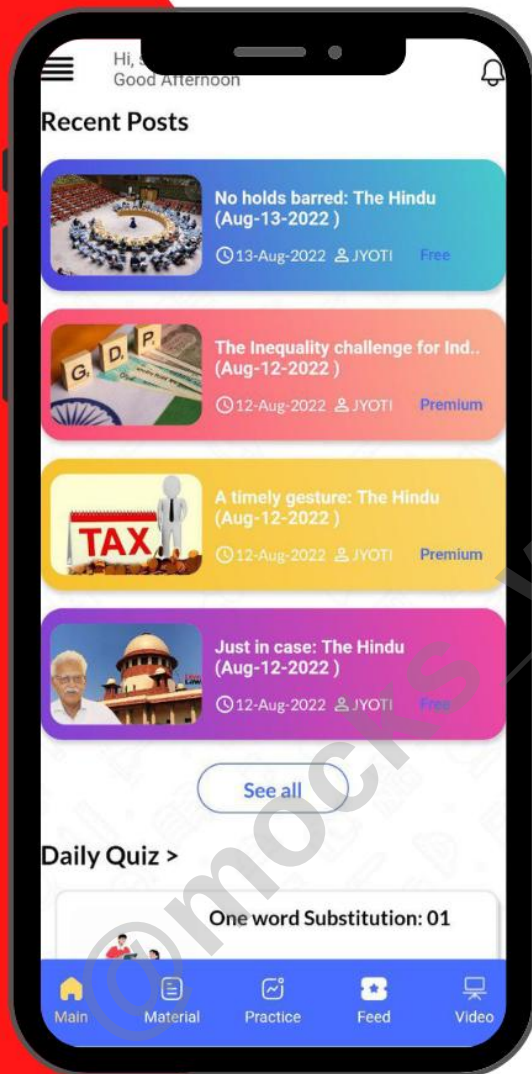
Click here to Start
Quiz in the App



Click here to Start Quiz of the
Editorial in the website

[Click here to download App](#)

[Click here to visit website](#)



Learn Vocabulary Through Reading Articles

English Madhyam